



VITALS

Check your vitals. Own your exam.



TEAS 7 Study Guide

Section breakdowns, practice questions with full explanations, and a 4-week study plan

NURSING SCHOOL ENTRANCE EXAM PREP

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Welcome

Before you dive in

The TEAS 7 (Test of Essential Academic Skills) is the entrance exam most nursing programs use to screen applicants. It covers four sections — Reading, Math, Science, and English and Language Usage — in about 3 hours and 29 minutes total. This guide walks through what each section actually tests, the mistakes that trip up most first-time test-takers, 18 practice questions with full explanations, and a 4-week study plan you can start today.

One honest note before you start: this guide is a solid foundation, not a substitute for volume. Nursing programs that require the TEAS generally want to see consistent practice over several weeks, not a single cram session. Use the study plan on the last page to pace yourself.

Section Breakdown

What each section actually tests

Reading

The Reading section tests how well you pull information from passages: main idea, inference, text structure, and evaluating source reliability. Expect 45 questions in 55 minutes.

Most common mistakes

- Answering from outside knowledge instead of what the passage actually says
- Confusing the main idea with an interesting supporting detail
- Missing signal words like 'however,' 'despite,' or 'therefore' that reveal structure

Math

The Math section covers dosage calculations, conversions, ratios, percentages, and basic algebra — the exact math you'll use constantly in clinical settings. 38 questions, 57 minutes.

Most common mistakes

- Skipping unit conversions (lb→kg, mL→L) before doing the main calculation
- Rushing percentage problems instead of converting to a decimal first
- Not double-checking whether an answer makes real-world sense (e.g., a dose 10x too high)

Science

Science covers anatomy & physiology (the bulk of it), biology, chemistry, and scientific reasoning. 50 questions, 60 minutes. A&P; alone is worth studying hardest.

Most common mistakes

- Memorizing organ names without understanding their function
- Mixing up similar-sounding terms (e.g., ureter vs. urethra)
- Ignoring basic chemistry — pH and bonding questions show up more than people expect

English and Language Usage

Grammar, sentence structure, vocabulary in context, and spelling. 37 questions, 28 minutes — the fastest-paced section, so speed and pattern recognition matter.

Most common mistakes

- Second-guessing grammar rules that were actually correct on first instinct
- Not recognizing Greek/Latin word roots common in medical vocabulary
- Running out of time because the section moves faster than the others

Practice

18 Practice Questions

Answer each question on your own before checking the answer key on the following pages. Questions are grouped by section, the same order they appear on the real exam.

Reading

1. A passage states, 'Despite the rain, the parade continued as planned.' What logical relationship does 'despite' express?

- A** Cause and effect
- B** Contrast
- C** Time sequence
- D** Comparison

2. What is the main purpose of a passage that compares flu and cold symptoms in a table?

- A** To persuade the reader
- B** To narrate an experience
- C** To inform and compare
- D** To express an opinion

3. In a patient education pamphlet, information organized under 'Before Surgery,' 'Day of Surgery,' and 'After Surgery' is an example of which text structure?

- A** Compare and contrast
- B** Chronological/sequential
- C** Problem and solution
- D** Cause and effect

4. Which source would be most reliable for statistics on national vaccination rates?

- A** A personal health blog
- B** A peer-reviewed CDC report
- C** A social media post
- D** An advertisement from a pharmaceutical company

Math

5. A patient needs 750 mg of a medication. Each tablet contains 250 mg. How many tablets are needed?

- A 2
- B 3
- C 4
- D 5

6. An IV is set to drip at 20 gtt/min, and the tubing delivers 15 gtt/mL. How many mL/hr does the patient receive?

- A 60 mL/hr
- B 80 mL/hr
- C 90 mL/hr
- D 100 mL/hr

7. Convert 0.35 to a simplified fraction.

- A $35/100$
- B $7/20$
- C $3/5$
- D $1/3$

8. What is 15% of 240?

- A 24
- B 30
- C 36
- D 42

9. A nurse needs to convert 176 lb to kilograms ($1 \text{ kg} \approx 2.2 \text{ lb}$). What is the closest value?

- A 70 kg
- B 76 kg
- C 80 kg
- D 86 kg

Science

10. Which organ is primarily responsible for filtering blood and producing urine?

- A Liver
- B Kidney
- C Pancreas
- D Spleen

11. In cellular respiration, which organelle produces the most ATP?

- A Nucleus
- B Ribosome
- C Mitochondrion
- D Golgi apparatus

12. What type of bond shares electrons between two atoms?

- A Ionic
- B Covalent
- C Hydrogen
- D Metallic

13. A pH of 3 indicates a substance that is:

- A Strongly basic
- B Neutral
- C Strongly acidic
- D Slightly basic

14. Which blood type is considered the universal donor?

- A A+
- B AB+
- C O-
- D B+

English

15. Choose the grammatically correct sentence:

- A** Neither of the nurses were late.
- B** Neither of the nurses was late.
- C** Neither of the nurse's was late.
- D** Neither of the nurses is being late.

16. What is the correct plural form of 'diagnosis'?

- A** Diagnosises
- B** Diagnosis
- C** Diagnoses
- D** Diagnosi

17. Identify the prefix in 'hypotension' and its meaning.

- A** hypo- = above
- B** hypo- = below
- C** hypo- = around
- D** hypo- = within

18. Which sentence uses the semicolon correctly?

- A** She studied all night; and passed the exam.
- B** She studied all night; she passed the exam.
- C** She studied; all night, she passed the exam.
- D** She studied all night, she; passed the exam.

Answer Key

Answers & Explanations

Reading

1. Correct answer: B. Contrast

'Despite' introduces a contrast: it signals that something happened even though a reason existed for it not to. The rain would normally cancel a parade, but the event went ahead anyway — that's contrast, not cause-and-effect.

2. Correct answer: C. To inform and compare

A side-by-side table of symptoms is a classic compare-and-contrast structure used to inform. There's no story, no argument, and no personal viewpoint being pushed.

3. Correct answer: B. Chronological/sequential

Headings tied to a timeline organize information in the order it happens — that's a chronological or sequential structure.

4. Correct answer: B. A peer-reviewed CDC report

Reliability comes down to source authority and lack of bias. A peer-reviewed government report is vetted and non-commercial, unlike a blog, social post, or an ad with a financial motive.

Math

5. Correct answer: B. 3

Divide the total dose by the dose per tablet: $750 \div 250 = 3$ tablets. Dosage calculations almost always reduce to this same pattern.

6. Correct answer: B. 80 mL/hr

First find mL/min: $20 \div 15 = 1.33$ mL/min. Multiply by 60 minutes: $1.33 \times 60 = 80$ mL/hr.

7. Correct answer: B. 7/20

$0.35 = 35/100$. Dividing both numerator and denominator by their greatest common factor (5) gives 7/20.

8. Correct answer: C. 36

Convert the percent to a decimal (0.15) and multiply: $0.15 \times 240 = 36$.

9. Correct answer: C. 80 kg

Divide pounds by 2.2: $176 \div 2.2 = 80$ kg exactly. This conversion factor is worth memorizing.

Science

10. Correct answer: B. Kidney

The kidneys filter waste and excess fluid from the blood to produce urine. The liver, pancreas, and spleen have different primary roles.

11. Correct answer: C. Mitochondrion

The mitochondrion is where the electron transport chain and oxidative phosphorylation occur — the stages that generate most of a cell's ATP.

12. Correct answer: B. Covalent

A covalent bond forms when two atoms share electron pairs. An ionic bond instead transfers electrons between atoms.

13. Correct answer: C. Strongly acidic

The pH scale runs 0–14, with 7 neutral. Values below 7 are acidic, and the farther from 7, the stronger the acid.

14. Correct answer: C. O-

O- red blood cells carry no A, B, or Rh antigens, so they don't trigger an immune reaction regardless of the recipient's blood type.

English

15. Correct answer: B. Neither of the nurses was late.

'Neither' is singular, so it takes a singular verb: 'was,' not 'were.'

16. Correct answer: C. Diagnoses

Words ending in '-is' from Greek (diagnosis, crisis, analysis) form their plural by changing '-is' to '-es.'

17. Correct answer: B. hypo- = below

'Hypo-' means below or under, so hypotension means blood pressure below normal. Its opposite, 'hyper-', means above or excessive.

18. Correct answer: B. She studied all night; she passed the exam.

A semicolon joins two complete, related sentences without a conjunction like 'and.' Both halves here are complete thoughts.

Plan

Your 4-Week Study Plan

Adjust the pace to how much time you have before your exam — the order of focus areas matters more than the exact week numbers.

Week	Focus	What to do
Week 1	Foundations	Take a full diagnostic practice test. Review Reading and English basics: text structures, grammar rules, and vocabulary roots. 20–30 min/day.
Week 2	Math & Science core	Drill dosage calculations, conversions, and percentages daily. Start Anatomy & Physiology review — this carries the most weight in Science. 30–40 min/day.
Week 3	Full-section practice	Timed practice by section, focusing on your two weakest areas from Week 1's diagnostic. Review every missed question's explanation, not just the correct answer. 40 min/day.
Week 4	Simulate & taper	Take 2 full timed practice tests under real conditions. Review mistakes daily, but taper total study time in the final 2 days before your exam to avoid burnout.

Keep Going

Want more than 18 questions?

This guide is your foundation. The Vitals app builds on it with an adaptive question bank that grows with AI, a tutor that re-explains any concept a different way — including in Spanish — timed practice tests, a predicted score, and a study plan built around your real exam date.

Start free at vitalsprep.com — no credit card required.

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